Day 44 - Mad River, Hamilton Bros., Betty Carter, Mad River-02.

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Blue Mountains section · hike 53 · Nottawasaga Bluffs and the Mad River

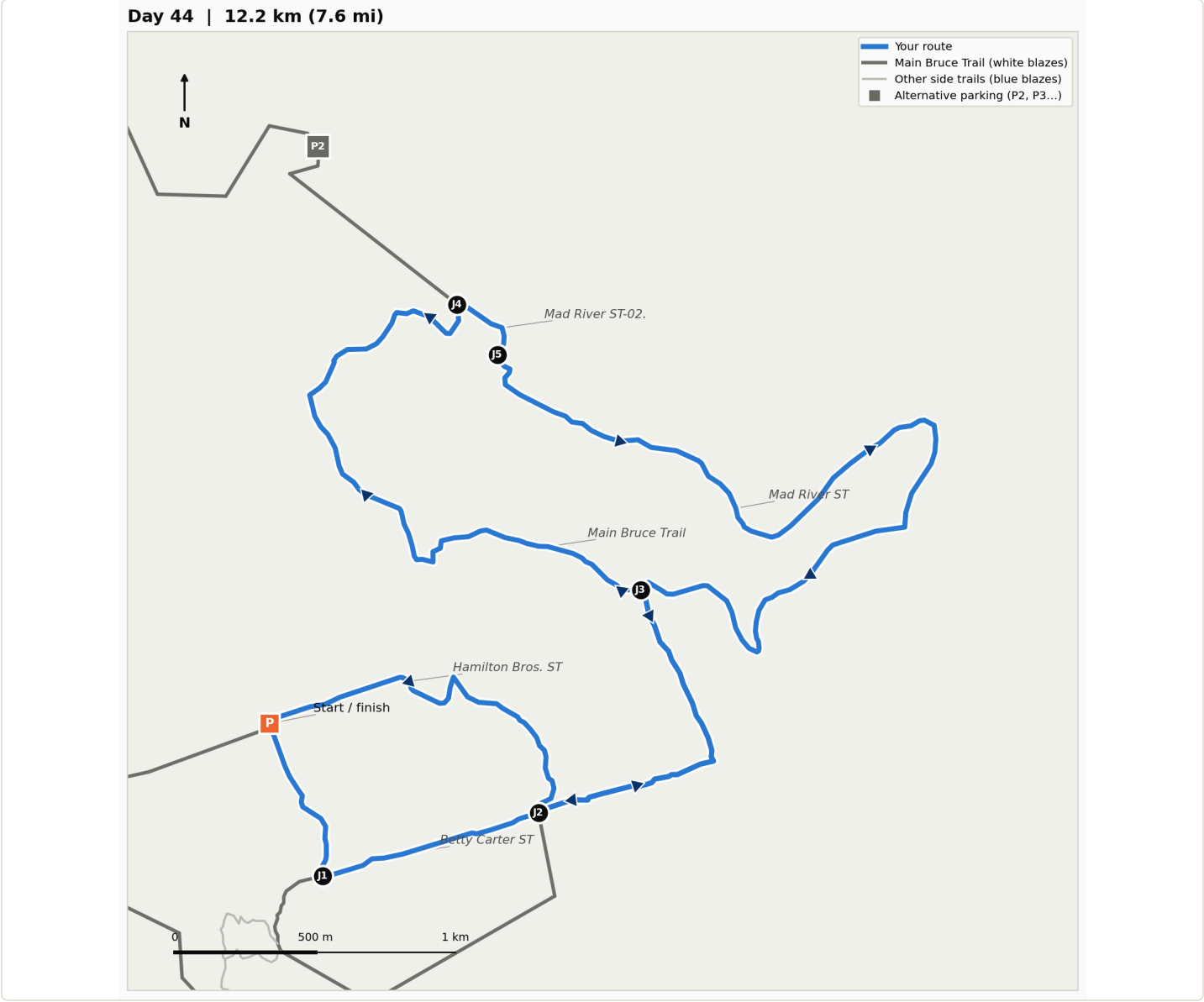
12.2 km / 7.6 mi	~3.7 h	6.4 km new	109 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Accessible only from Con 10 South, this small parking area off 15/16 Sideroad is provided by the Nottawasaga Valley Conservation Authority. Google Maps. **Paid: $15 + HST per vehicle (day)** · scan QR code on site signs or HotSpot app/website; NVCA requires a parking pass at its conservation areas (except Tottenham, New Lowell); this small lot not named specifically; annual pass $70

Navigate: import *day44_hike053.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Mad River Side Trail (3.8 km); Hamilton Bros. Side Trail (1.5 km); Betty Carter Side Trail (0.8 km); Mad River Side Trail-02. (0.3 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** A small NVCA lot at 8861 Nottawasaga 15/16 Sideroad, open dawn to dusk. A day pass costs $15 + HST per vehicle (HotSpot or QR code). Approach through Singhampton, as the NVCA directs, not along 15/16 Sideroad and Concession 8.
- **Betty Carter Side Trail:** A short, gently graded trail in the Nottawasaga Bluffs Conservation Area. The area has hidden fissures and crevices, so stay on the marked trail and keep Zappy leashed, which is required.

- **Mad River Side Trail:** Drops off the escarpment toward the Mad River and the village of Glen Huron. The descent is steep, and there is a lot of climbing and descending overall.
- **Road walking:** Part of the Mad River Side Trail follows roads, including Concession 8 South and a rough seasonal dirt road. Keep Zappy close.
- **Hamilton Bros. Side Trail:** The last leg of the route. No description of it was found.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Devil's Glen Provincial Park: Enter from County Rd 124 map	Free	5.3	1070 m	

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Accessible only from Con 10 South, this small parking area off 15/16 Sideroad is provided.... Head south on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail.
0.6	0.4	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Betty Carter Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
1.4	0.9	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right; the blue-blazed Hamilton Bros. Side Trail goes off on your left.)
2.8	1.7	J3: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Mad River Side Trail goes off on your right.)
5.2	3.2	J4: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Mad River Side Trail-02., heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
5.5	3.4	J5: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Mad River Side Trail, heading south-east.
7.5	4.7	Heads-up: The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
8.0	5.0	Heads-up: The next 1.2 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
9.3	5.8	J3: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
10.6	6.6	J2: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Hamilton Bros. Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left; the Betty Carter Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
11.3	7.1	Heads-up: The next 0.8 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
12.2	7.6	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the NVCA, Trail Run Project, Fastest Known Time and Streets of Toronto.